The Fourth Sheet

Example report · SMEs

SAMPLE DATA · invented figures for demonstration

Which products and services are growing?

Period: August 2026. Revenue, gross margin and growth (year on year) by product or service line over 24 months. Pick a line and every number, chart and note follows it.

How final is this data?

August 2026 Locked August 2026 is locked (closed 2 Sep 2026). These numbers won't change.

Trades

Gross margin, not profit

Gross margin is not profit. Job gross margin = revenue less materials, subcontractors and technician time charged to the job at $68 an hour (wages and all on-costs). Not included: technician time not charged to any job (travel, training, waiting), and overheads (office wages, marketing, vehicles, rent, insurance, IT, depreciation, interest). Profit is what's left after those. Wages include their on-costs: super (12%) and leave as it's earned. No payroll tax: wages are under Queensland's $1.3 million threshold.

From gross margin to profit

August's jobs made $94,153 gross margin (47.2%). Technician time not charged to jobs took $27,812 and overheads $59,500, leaving $6,841 profit before tax (3.4% of revenue). To cover overheads, jobs need a 43.8% gross margin on average.

Gross margin on jobs	$94,153
Technician wages and on-costs	$72,352
Technician time charged to jobs (at cost)	$44,540
Technician time not charged to jobs	$27,812
Gross profit (the P&L)	$66,341
Overheads (operating expenses, depreciation, interest)	$59,500
Profit before tax (the P&L)	$6,841
Revenue	$199,523
Gross margin on jobs, %	47.2%
Profit before tax, % of revenue	3.4%
Gross margin jobs need just to cover overheads and time not charged	**43.8%**

Line: All

August against August last year
28.6%
$199,523 against $155,118

Year to date against the same period last year
14.1%
$415,133 against $363,706

Gross margin, year to date
45.2%
$187,639 before overheads

What it shows

Revenue is 14.1% up on the same period last year, year to date ($415,133 against $363,706). Maintenance contracts make the highest gross margin (63.9%); Installations the lowest (38.2%). The business needs 43.8% gross margin just to cover overheads.

What you'd do about it

Installations: 38.2% gross margin, 3.2 points over the 35.0% target ($8,530 ahead on $265,800 this financial year to date). Maintenance contracts: 63.9% gross margin, 28.9 points over the 35.0% target ($26,187 ahead on $90,700 this financial year to date).

Line: Maintenance contracts

August against August last year
21.9%
$45,350 against $37,200

Year to date against the same period last year
21.9%
$90,700 against $74,400

Gross margin, year to date
63.9%
$57,932 before overheads

What it shows

Maintenance contracts brought in $90,700 this financial year to date, 21.9% on the same period last year (faster than the business as a whole, 14.1%), at a 63.9% gross margin (above the 45.2% overall).

What you'd do about it

Maintenance contracts: 63.9% gross margin, 28.9 points over the 35.0% target ($26,187 ahead on $90,700 this financial year to date).

Line: Installations

August against August last year
27.3%
$122,800 against $96,500

Year to date against the same period last year
6.9%
$265,800 against $248,600

Gross margin, year to date
38.2%
$101,560 before overheads

What it shows

Installations brought in $265,800 this financial year to date, 6.9% on the same period last year (slower than the business as a whole, 14.1%), at a 38.2% gross margin (below the 45.2% overall).

What you'd do about it

Installations: 38.2% gross margin, 3.2 points over the 35.0% target ($8,530 ahead on $265,800 this financial year to date).

Line: Call-outs and repairs

August against August last year
46.5%
$31,373 against $21,418

Year to date against the same period last year
44.0%
$58,633 against $40,706

Gross margin, year to date
48.0%
$28,147 before overheads

What it shows

Call-outs and repairs brought in $58,633 this financial year to date, 44.0% on the same period last year (faster than the business as a whole, 14.1%), at a 48.0% gross margin (above the 45.2% overall).

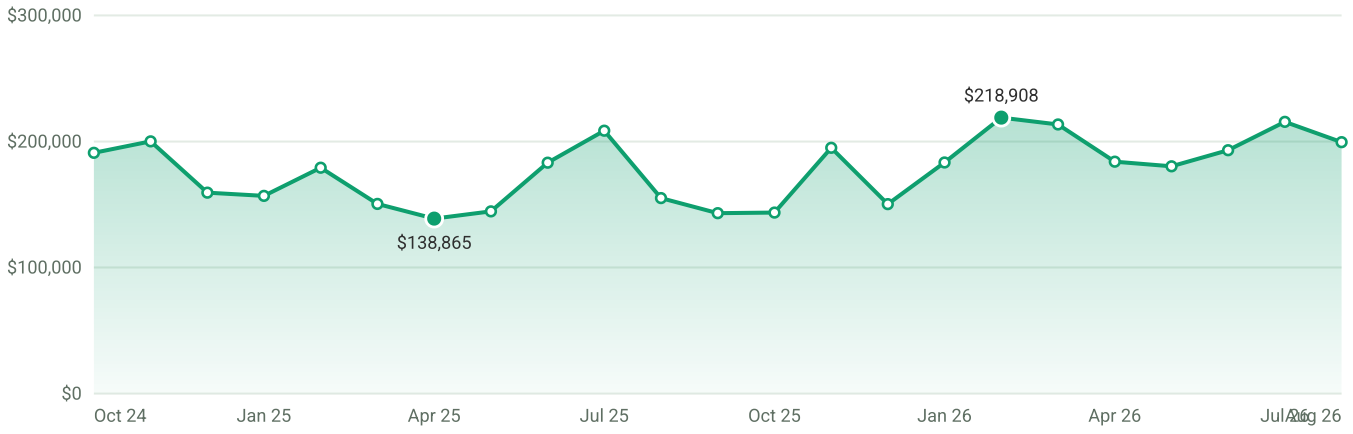
What you'd do about it

Call-outs and repairs: 48.0% gross margin, 13.0 points over the 35.0% target ($7,625 ahead on $58,633 this financial year to date).

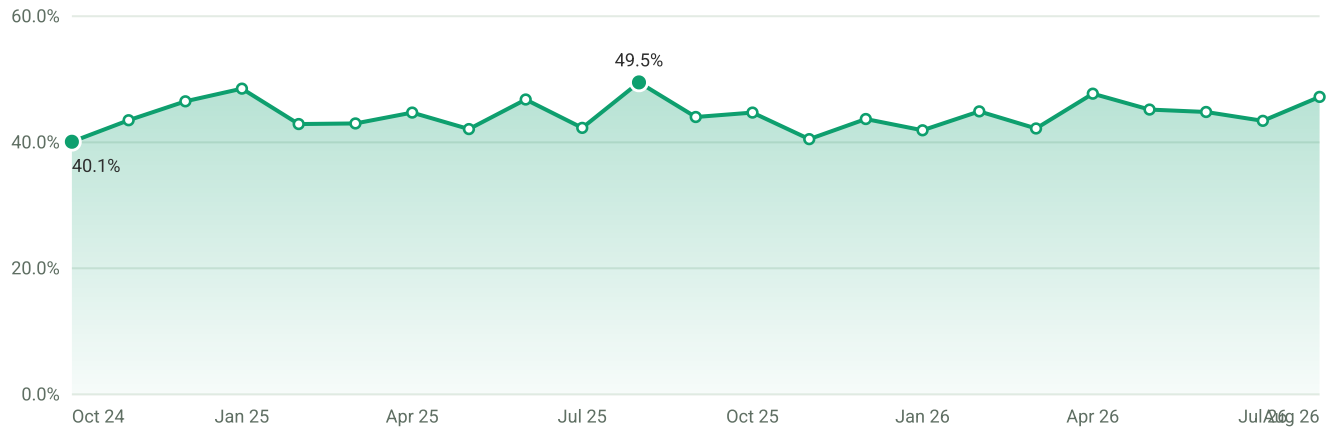
Every line at once

Revenue, gross margin and growth by line, by month

All · Revenue $



All · Gross margin %



Growth is year on year: each month against the same month a year earlier. Every month, by line, is in the spreadsheet download.

By line: financial year to date (Jul to Aug 2026) against the same period last year

	Year to date	Same period last year	Growth	Gross margin $	Gross margin %
Maintenance contracts	$90,700	$74,400	21.9%	$57,932	63.9%
Installations	$265,800	$248,600	6.9%	$101,560	38.2%
Call-outs and repairs	$58,633	$40,706	44.0%	$28,147	48.0%
Total	$415,133	$363,706	14.1%	$187,639	45.2%

Made with Python: laid out in HTML and CSS, printed to PDF in Chromium.